

Fig. 4: gsch2pcb

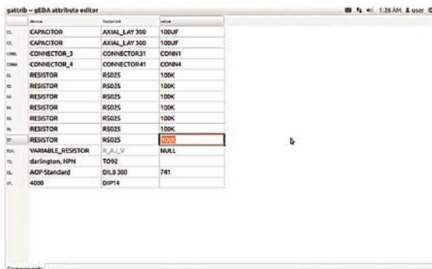


Fig. 5: Attribute Editor



Fig. 6: PCB tool

quick look over 'gschem' before you start your first schematic with gEDA suite. Save all the schematics in a directory. Hierarchical and multi-page designs are also possible but the schematics should be carefully saved in the same directory.

Symbol libraries are very rich and there is a vast database of new symbols over the Internet (www.gedasymbols.org). But, you would always be required to create new symbols. Creating new symbols is very quick in gEDA suite. You can either edit an existing symbol or create a new one. The detailed description of creating a new symbol can be found at 'wiki.geda-project.org/geda:gschem_symbol_creation'.

Once the schematic is ready, you can choose to make a PCB. The tool used to prepare the schematic for the PCB is 'gsch2pcb' (shown in Fig. 4).

Run 'gsch2pcb' and click 'Add Project' button indicated as box 1 in Fig. 4 and select the correct directory. The name of the project will reflect in box 2. Click 'Add Button' highlighted by box 4 and add all the schematic pages one by one. The added schematic will reflect in the area indicated by box 3 in the figure.

Select all the schematic pages and hit 'Edit Attributes' button. This will open up attribute window for the complete schematic as shown in Fig. 5.

Here enter the correct footprints for all the parts and save the entries. Otherwise, parts with incorrect footprints will not be imported in the PCB design software. The footprint name can be taken from the library of the PCB tool. After putting in the entire correct packages, click 'Update Layout' in 'gsch2pcb' tool. Your schematic will now be directly imported to another tool called 'PCB' used for PCB design. Fig. 6 shows the PCB tool.

If you are not an expert in PCB design, refer 'www.delorie.com/pcb/docs/gs/gsh.html' before you start routing. After the layout is complete, you can export the layout for BOM, netlist and output image. ●

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